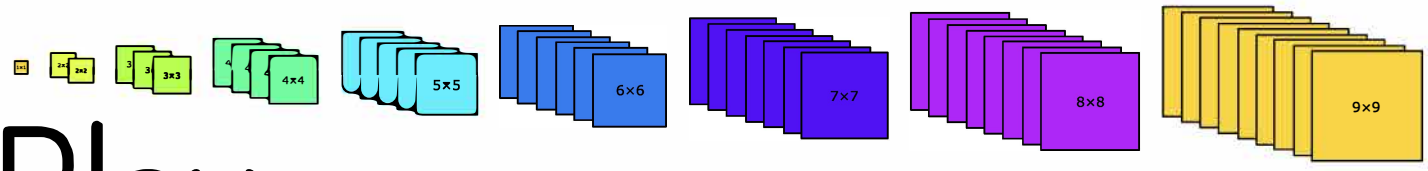
MathsJam Shout

January 2026
UK Gathering-inspired

At the end of Nov 2025, UK MathsJammers gathered for the 2025 MathsJam UK Gathering. Here's a flavour of what they got up to!



Play

2025 Squares

Matthew Scroggs told us that 2025 is the sum of the first 9 cube numbers and also the square of the sum of the first 9 numbers, and showed us how to represent this fact by arranging one 1 by 1 square, two 2 by 2 squares, three 3 by 3 squares, and so on up to nine 9 by 9 squares inside a 45 by 45 square.

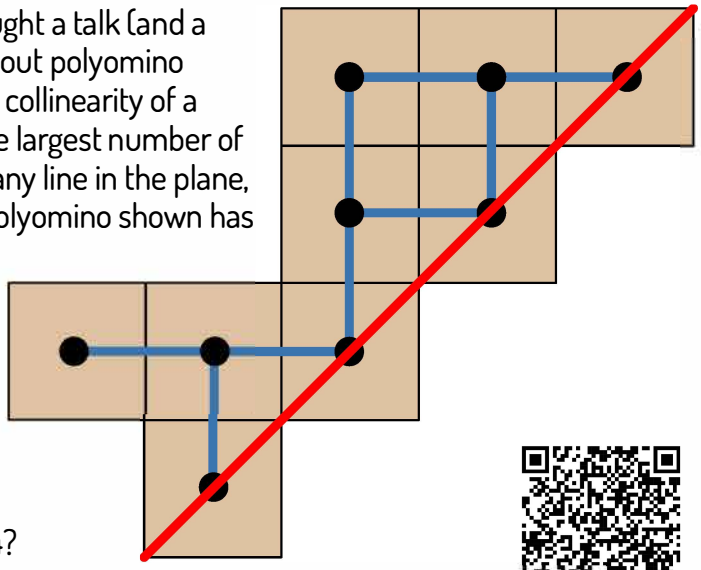
Can you recreate the arrangement? What other numbers will this work for?

Scroggs' Interactive Square Thing:
mscroggs.co.uk/squares

Puzzle

Polyomino Collinearity

Dave Budd brought a talk (and a competition) about polyomino collinearity. The collinearity of a polyomino is the largest number of cell centres on any line in the plane, so the square polyomino shown has a collinearity of 4.



What's the largest polyomino you can find with a collinearity of 4?

Dave's Interactive Polyomino Thing:
polycomp.pythonanywhere.com/app/event/mjg25poly

Find

Fridge Magnet Equations

$$11^2 \times 9\frac{1}{3} = 1129\frac{1}{3}$$

$$3^4 \times 425 = 34425$$

$$2^5 \times 9^2 = 2592$$

$$\sqrt{2\frac{2}{3}} = 2\sqrt{\frac{2}{3}}$$

Katie Steckles found a list of equations that feel like they shouldn't work, and used fridge magnets to recreate them. What other examples can you find?

The Futility Closet blog post:
futilitycloset.com/2025/07/11/printers-errors

MathsJam Shout is a monthly sheet of ideas for activities to do at a MathsJam night. It's created using suggestions from a different MathsJam each month, and if you'd like to submit suggestions for a month in the future, email **katie@mathsjam.com**

Maths Jam is a monthly opportunity for like-minded self-confessed maths enthusiasts to get together in a pub and share stuff they like. Puzzles, games, problems, or just anything they think is cool or interesting. Monthly Maths Jam nights happen in over 70 locations around the world, on the second-to-last Tuesday of each month. To find your nearest Maths Jam, visit the website at **mathsjam.com.**